Marco Laffranchi

Senior Business Development & Growth Leader | New Markets | Technology Commercialization
Winterthur, ZH, Switzerland
Swiss citizen
Languages: Italian (native); German, French, English and Spanish (fluent)
Inventor/co-inventor of 9 industrial technology patents
+41 (0)79 671 15 57 | Laffranchi.Marco@gmail.com

Profile

Business development and engineering leader with a track record of identifying growth opportunities, translating complex technologies into commercially viable offerings, and building the capabilities required to scale them.

Experienced in market analysis, strategic customer development, product and portfolio strategy, business cases, pricing, revenue forecasting, industrialization and go-to-market planning. Led multidisciplinary teams under direct CEO/CTO mandates, coordinated cross-functional initiatives across engineering, operations, sales, marketing and finance, and supported more than CHF 20M in investment decisions.

Combines strong commercial judgment with deep technical understanding, enabling effective work at the interface between customers, technology, operations and executive management. International experience across industrial high-tech, advanced manufacturing, sensor systems, scientific instrumentation and emerging technology markets.

Core Leadership & Business Development Competencies

- New-market development, growth strategy and strategic business development.
- Identification and evaluation of adjacent markets, applications and technology-driven growth opportunities.
- Business cases, investment proposals, ROI analysis, pricing strategy and revenue forecasting.
- Strategic customer engagement, requirement definition and value-proposition development.
- Product and portfolio strategy, technology roadmaps and platform development.
- Industrialization, design-for-manufacturing and transition from manual to scalable production.
- Leadership of multidisciplinary teams and cross-functional programs.
- Competitive intelligence, patent strategy and technology differentiation.
- International stakeholder management across Europe, Asia and North America.

Professional Experience

Independent Consultant / Engineering Services, Winterthur (CH)

Business Development and Technology Consultant **04/2026 – present**

- Develop business cases, technical concepts and commercialization strategies for technology-driven products and industrial systems.
- Defined the concept and industrialization strategy for an automated thin-film metal-deposition line targeting investment below CHF 100k and unit cost below CHF 5 at scale, with emphasis on competitive differentiation and scalable production.
- Developed a business case, system concept and patent proposals for a vibration-control solution addressing an emerging quantum-computing application.

Kistler Instrumente AG, Winterthur (CH)

Head of Technology-Driven Business Development / Strategic Technology Analyst **01/2020 – 03/2026**

- Led an eight-person business development and technology team and coordinated approximately 20 colleagues across engineering, operations, sales, marketing and finance.
- Identified and assessed new markets, applications and technology opportunities and translated them into product concepts, investment proposals and go-to-market strategies under a direct CEO/CTO mandate.
- Developed business cases supporting more than CHF 20M in product and market investment decisions, including market sizing, regional pricing, revenue forecasts, technical feasibility and competitive positioning.
- Engaged strategic customers worldwide to identify unmet needs, define value propositions and determine willingness-to-pay; aligned global sales centres on country-level market and revenue plans.
- Built product and technology roadmaps linking customer demand, internal capabilities, differentiation and industrialization requirements.
- Established a model for transitioning selected products from manual assembly to automated production, supporting scalability, cost reduction and future growth.
- Led sensor miniaturization, modularization and platform-development initiatives and defined competitive differentiation through market, patent and technology analysis.
- Managed strategic collaborations with industrial customers, including development work in semiconductor equipment, predictive maintenance and vibration-control applications.

Head of Sensor Development Engineering **01/2014 – 12/2019**

- Led six expert engineers and coordinated four supporting contributors, with responsibility for technology development, product platforms and industrialization.
- Managed technology and product portfolios, resource priorities and capability development under a direct CEO/CTO mandate.
- Built team structures, engineering practices and knowledge-transfer processes to support organizational growth and reduce dependency on individual experts.
- Directed platform development and product improvements across demanding industrial applications, balancing performance, manufacturability, reliability and cost.

Senior Engineering and Project Manager **05/2010 – 12/2013**

- Managed multidisciplinary product-development projects from opportunity definition through industrialization and market launch.
- Developed and launched a high-temperature gas-turbine sensor portfolio, including ATEX-certified amplification electronics with leading signal-to-noise performance and reliability.
- Developed and launched a shock-wave and high-speed characterization portfolio that reached approximately 50% share of its target segment within three years, with particularly strong growth in Asia.

Bieri Engineering GmbH, Winterthur (CH)

Lead Engineer for High-End Research and Industrial Systems **09/2008 – 04/2010**

- Led a small engineering team and supervised assembly activities for complex, high-value technical systems.
- Delivered custom systems for international research and industrial customers, managing technical definition, supplier interfaces, cost constraints and implementation.
- Engineered and assembled a CHF 5M cryogenic tank for a NASA space experiment and launch conditions.
- Designed and built detector and cryogenic systems for ETH Zurich, CERN and the University of Bern within demanding technical and budget constraints.
- Worked with EMPA and Sulzer Innotec on hydrogen-storage and energy-system development projects.

International Research Experience

ETH Zurich / CERN, Geneva (CH)

Postdoctoral Researcher and Lecturer **2005 – 2008**

- Coordinated scientific activities across an international collaboration of seven universities and served as CERN laboratory safety officer for 35 researchers.
- Lectured in particle physics at ETH Zurich.
- Authored or co-authored approximately 25 peer-reviewed publications in particle physics and detector technology, with more than 1,500 citations.

Selected Industry & Technology Exposure

- Industrial sensing and instrumentation, advanced manufacturing, automation and precision systems.
- Semiconductor equipment, predictive maintenance, vibration control and emerging quantum technologies.
- Cryogenic, vacuum and scientific instrumentation for large international research programs.
- Gas turbines, high-temperature applications, high-dynamic measurements and harsh-environment electronics.
- Hydrogen storage, thermal systems and energy-related engineering studies.

Education

ETH Zurich, Zurich (CH)

Diploma and Doctorate in Experimental Particle Physics **1995 – 2004**

- Specialization in particle-accelerator and detector technology.